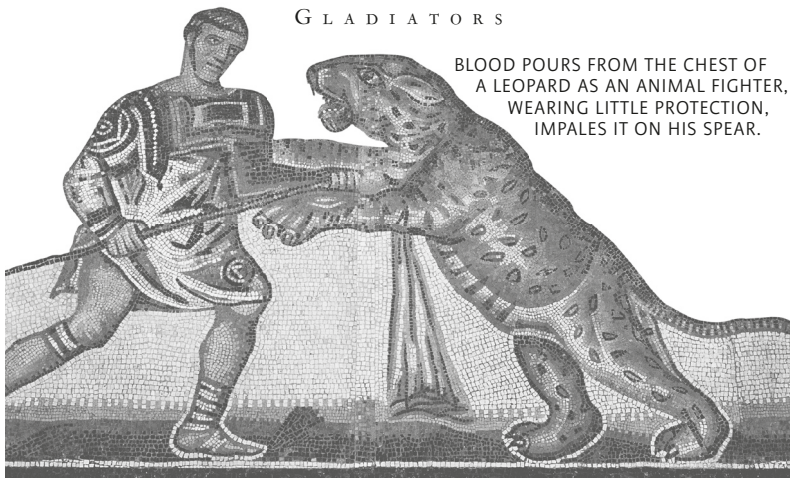




BLOOD POURS FROM THE CHEST OF A LEOPARD AS AN ANIMAL FIGHTER, WEARING LITTLE PROTECTION, IMPALES IT ON HIS SPEAR.

Wearing little more than tunics and leg wrappings, and armed only with long spears, animal fighters hunted a variety of animals, from harmless hares to human-eating lions. The *venatores* stalked them on foot or chased them on horseback.

32 elephants, 10 elks, 10 tigers, 60 tame lions, 10 wild lions, 30 leopards, 10 hyenas, 10 camels, 20 wild asses (perhaps zebras), 40 wild horses, 6 hippos, and a rhinoceros. All the animals were either killed or displayed to the crowd.

TRAINED ELEPHANTS WROTE IN THE SAND WITH THEIR TRUNKS.

The *bestiarii* were on standby to whip the animals into a rage, making the show even more cruel than it already was.

Some idea of the different types of animal seen in the Colosseum comes from a show organized by Emperor Philip the Arab in 247 CE to celebrate the 1,000th birthday of Rome. Records show that there were

Virtual reality hunts

But why were the Romans so cruel to animals? Well, you might think they were cruel, but most Romans didn't think like this. Hunting animals was a favorite Roman blood sport, and watching a hunt in the arena was a reminder of this. Most people who lived in Rome never left the city, so